



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Jonathan Edwards Classical Academy
School Website: <https://jecanashville.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Jonathan Edwards Classical Academy (JECA), Nashville, TN 37189, presents a robust Classical Christian program that aligns strongly with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School. The public materials consistently articulate a God-centered, Christ-focused formation that integrates theology with classical pedagogy (Trivium and Quadrivium), a Great Books approach, and explicit emphasis on virtue, wonder, and the cultivation of wisdom. The school features a clearly defined mission to form lifelong learners who pursue truth, goodness, and beauty as revealed in Scripture, with explicit attention to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) across grade bands, a capstone senior thesis, and Latin study. Faculty are described as professional, virtuous mentors who embody the curriculum, and parents are positioned as partners in a Christian formation process. Taken together, JECA's public-facing content demonstrates a consistent Classical Christian orientation across religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement.

Key evidence points: - Religious and metaphysical foundations are foregrounded through God-centered formulation, Biblical integration, theology, and worship-centric language across admissions, mission/vision, and program descriptions.

- The school's stated purpose centers on formation, virtue, and love of the true, good, and beautiful, with explicit reference to God's Word and worldview. - Curriculum highlights explicitly include the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar logic rhetoric), Great Books/primary sources, Latin, and an integrated historical worldview. - Pedagogy emphasizes the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), contemplative/restful elements, and Socratic/seminar-style discourse at upper levels, with memorization and recitation as memory-building practices. - Faculty language centers on professional, virtuous teachers who model character and serve as the living curriculum; the mission/vision page highlights teachers who "ascribe everything to God." - Parent/-community partnership with families, including homeschool avenues and open engagement, is integral to JECA's model.

Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

Given the breadth and consistency of classical-content across all six categories, JECA meets the core criteria of a classical school with alignment to liberal arts education, Great Books, theological grounding, and a Trivium-centered pedagogy, while maintaining a distinctive Christian frame. The site does not present countervailing signals (e.g., secular or purely job-prep framing) to indicate a move away from classical aims. Therefore, the overall assessment is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - No major needle-moving changes are required since this is already a CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories. If desired, the school could further strengthen explicit articulation of Great Conversation and Great Books in every department (beyond mentions) to reinforce the catechetical integration of classical texts with contemporary disciplines.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - JECA emphasizes a God-centered, God-promoting education and formation “in Christ,” with public statements about Biblical authority and a Christian worldview across mission/vision and admissions materials. - The Mission & Vision section articulates forming “lifelong Godly affections” and teaching that which is true, good, and beautiful as revealed in God’s Word, with a commitment to shaping the world for Christ. - Distinctively Christian framing explicitly integrates Christ into all disciplines and highlights Scripture as central to learning.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: God-centered, Christ, Scripture, Word, theology, worship, prayer, sacraments, biblical integration, liturgy. (Observed in JECA materials; e.g., God-centered education, Word/Sacraments in growth statements, theological framing in mission/vision.)

- Negative keywords present: None observed (the site does not emphasize secular relativism, secular humanism, or value-neutral frameworks).

Why this rating - The materials present a transcendent, theologically grounded framework with explicit liturgical and communal cues (e.g., worship, prayer, sacraments) and a theology-centered interpretation of education. This aligns with the Positive Keywords for category 1 (truth/goodness/beauty as transcendentals, theology, liturgy) and shows little to no negative signals in the public materials. CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission emphasizes formation, virtue, and wisdom, anchored in Christian formation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. - The school describes formation of lifelong learners and the cultivation of Godly affections, consistent with paideia-oriented aims. The Great Conversation/formation framing appears in the classical description. - The Classical Education Model highlights a long-term formation through the Trivium, primary sources, and capstone projects, signaling formation over mere information.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/-good/beautiful, scholé (implied in mission), classical mission, human flourishing. (Found in mission/vision and public classical-education descriptions.) - Negative keywords present: None observed (the site does not foreground college/workforce-readiness as primary telos). The emphasis remains formation-oriented.

Why this rating - The content centers on formation and the pursuit of transcendentals (truth, goodness, beauty) within a classical framework, not merely job-readiness. CLASSICAL

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials describe the Seven Liberal Arts focus (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Quadrivium, plus history as a through-line with Great Books/primary sources (Plato, Augustine), and Latin/-classical languages. - Great Books / primary sources are explicitly cited (Plato, Augustine) and the senior thesis capstone is highlighted. - History is studied in an integrated classical manner, rather than as “social studies.” The emphasis on Western civilization and timeless texts is present.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Trivium, Quadrivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, primary sources, Latin, Western civilization, history, capstone senior thesis. - Negative keywords present: None observed (no explicit move to replace Great Books with social studies terms or project-focused, non-textual approaches in the core description).

Why this rating - The curriculum language is unmistakably classical, centering on the liberal arts, great books, and classical languages; history is framed in a Western civilization/historical context rather than purely social studies. CLASSICAL

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Trivium is named as the organizing pedagogical spine (grammar stage, logic stage, rhetoric stage) with capstone senior thesis. - The lower grades emphasize a memory-rich, possibly recitation-based approach (grammar stage; emphasis on foundational skills and order). - Upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion/seminars, debates, and rhetorical training; opportunities for speeches and rhetoric work. - The public materials emphasize integration of faith and reason, and the teacher as mentor within the classical framework (living curriculum).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Trivium, grammar, logic, rhetoric, capstone, Socratic discussion (as part of the classical pedagogy), memory work/recitation, rhetorical training, living curriculum, teacher as mentor.

- Negative keywords present: None observed in the public materials (no strong signals of project-based-only or non-traditional pedagogy driving instruction). The site describes a traditional, contemplative pace aligned with schol .

Why this rating - The pedagogy is squarely classical: Trivium-based progression, emphasis on memorization and recitation in lower grades, and Socratic/seminar-rich upper-level work align with classical pedagogy signals. CLASSICAL

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission/vision emphasizes professional teachers who “ascribe everything to God” and model virtuous learning, indicating teachers who serve as living exemplars and the core of the school culture. - The school highlights teachers who are mentors, living curriculum, and a collegial culture; the catalogs describe portraits of teacher achievements and expectations. - There is explicit emphasis on teachers who model virtue, skill, and knowledge, and on the teacher-student relationship as central to formation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: professional teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, teachers as exemplars, virtue, character formation. - Negative keywords present: None observed (no “facilitator” or “guides on the side” framing).

Why this rating - The content strongly emphasizes teacher quality, living-lesson modeling, and a collaborative faculty culture that embodies the classical curriculum. CLASSICAL

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school frames itself as partnering with Christian families; admissions materials emphasize co-educative partnership with parents, and there are explicit pathways for homeschool families (Homeschool A La Carte) aligned with the classical mission. - There are open-door policies for visits (parents welcome) and opportunities for formation and engagement through book groups, gatherings, and classical education education for parents (as implied by mission statements and parent-oriented programs). - The presence of Homeschool A La Carte options demonstrates ongoing parent engagement and involvement in the curriculum and learning pathways.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, classical book clubs, family involvement, home-centered learning, open campus, parental engagement.

- Negative keywords present: None observed (no friction consumer language; no “customer” framing; not limited to student as customer).

Why this rating - JECA presents a robust partnership model with families and multiple pathways for parent engagement and formation, consistent with the category’s ideal signals. CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable, as the school is classified CLASSICAL across all six categories. No needle-moving changes are required to reach full classical alignment.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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